

Miso Congee Bowl

A warming, umami-rich rice porridge with white miso, shiitake mushrooms, and sesame oil — simple, nourishing, and ready in 20 minutes.

INGREDIENTS

- 0.5 cups short-grain white rice (or jasmine)
- 4 cups water
- 1 cups vegetable broth (gluten-free)
- 2 tablespoons white miso paste (shiro miso)
- 4 ounces dried shiitake mushrooms
- 1 tablespoons fresh ginger, peeled and grated
- 2 garlic cloves, minced
- 1 tablespoons toasted sesame oil
- 1 tablespoons tamari (gluten-free soy sauce)
- 3 scallions, thinly sliced
- 1 tablespoons sesame seeds, toasted
- 1 nori sheet, cut into thin strips
- 4 ounces soft silken tofu, cubed (optional)
- 1 teaspoons chili oil or sriracha, to taste

STEPS

1. Rehydrate the mushrooms: Soak 4 ounces dried shiitake mushrooms in 1 cup of hot water for 10 minutes. Once softened, squeeze out excess liquid, slice thinly, and reserve the soaking liquid — it adds deep umami to the congee.
2. Start the congee base: Combine 0.5 cups short-grain white rice (or jasmine), 4 cups water, 1 cups vegetable broth (gluten-free), and the reserved mushroom soaking liquid in a medium saucepan. Bring to a boil over medium-high heat, stirring occasionally.
3. Simmer low and slow: Reduce heat to low. Add 1 tablespoons fresh ginger, peeled and grated and 2 garlic cloves, minced. Simmer uncovered, stirring every few minutes, until the rice breaks down into a thick, creamy porridge. Add more water if it becomes too thick.
4. Sauté the mushrooms: While the congee simmers, heat 1 tablespoons toasted sesame oil in a small skillet over medium-high heat. Add the sliced mushrooms and cook until lightly caramelized, about 4–5 minutes. Add 1 tablespoons tamari (gluten-

free soy sauce) and toss to coat. Set aside.

5. Dissolve the miso: Remove the congee from heat. Ladle a few tablespoons of the hot porridge into a small bowl, add 2 tablespoons white miso paste (shiro miso), and stir until completely dissolved — never boil miso directly, as heat destroys its beneficial probiotics. Stir the dissolved miso back into the pot.

6. Add tofu (optional): If using 4 ounces soft silken tofu, cubed (optional), gently fold the cubes into the congee off the heat and let them warm through for 2 minutes.

7. Assemble and serve: Ladle the congee into bowls. Top with the sautéed mushrooms, 3 scallions, thinly sliced, 1 tablespoons sesame seeds, toasted, 1 nori sheet, cut into thin strips strips, and a drizzle of 1 teaspoons chili oil or sriracha, to taste. Serve immediately while hot.

NOTES

****Make it your own:**** Swap white miso for red miso (aka miso) for a deeper, more robust flavor — reduce to 1 tbsp as it is saltier. ****Rice ratio:**** For a thicker congee, use a 1:6 rice-to-liquid ratio; for a thinner, soupier consistency go up to 1:10. ****Speed tip:**** Use leftover cooked rice and reduce simmering time to just 10–15 minutes.

****Toppings to try:**** crispy fried shallots, pickled daikon, a soft-boiled (or vegan equivalent: marinated tofu), or a drizzle of chili crisp oil.